

UNITED STATES PATENT APPLICATION

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**DASHFACE: SYSTEM AND METHOD FOR REAL-TIME MICRO-
EXPRESSION SURVEILLANCE, IDENTITY VERIFICATION, AND
CONTENT MONETIZATION OF CONTRACT DELIVERY
PERSONNEL VIA IN-CABIN BIOMETRIC MONITORING**

**A Patent-Poem on the Last Extraction: The Human Face as
Platform Content**

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ABSTRACT

A food delivery platform comprising an in-cabin camera system trained continuously on the delivery driver's face, wherein a micro-expression analysis layer monitors emotional valence, identity congruence, and entertainment value in real time, and wherein said facial data is streamed to the customer's mobile device as both identity verification ("Is this really Samantha?") and live content, creating a dual-use surveillance-entertainment architecture that monetizes the driver's face as a platform asset. The system comprises: (a) a Facial Congruence Engine (FCE) comparing the driver's live micro-expressions against their registered profile to detect imposture, fatigue, resentment, or the precise moment when the driver eats one of the customer's fries; (b) a Driver Entertainment Score (DES) measuring the driver's capacity to produce engaging live content while operating a motor vehicle in traffic; (c) a Precariat Performance Index (PPI) converting driver emotional availability into a fungible reputation score tiered from Platinum Authenticity to Shadow; (d) a tip-modulation algorithm correlating real-time facial positivity metrics to suggested gratuity; (e) an Affective Surge Pricing

Module imposing elevated positivity requirements during high-demand periods; (f) a Customer Delight Micro-Bonus triggered by the customer's own smile during unboxing; and (g) a content marketplace wherein high-performing driver-creators are surfaced preferentially in the dispatch queue, creating a system in which the contract precariat must not only deliver food but perform joy while doing so, or be algorithmically deprioritized into economic invisibility.

PRIOR ART — CONVERSATIONAL

The invention originated in a text thread on the evening of April 30, 2026.

Party A: how do I know that is really Samantha delivering my food **Party B:** you could just look at her when she arrives **Party A:** no I need to know the whole time **Party A:** like what if the real Samantha handed it off to someone else in the parking lot **Party B:** then you would receive your food from someone who is not Samantha **Party A:** exactly **Party A:** I need a cam on her face the whole time **Party B:** you want to watch a stranger drive your burrito across town **Party A:** I want to verify that the face delivering my burrito is the face I was promised **Party B:** that is the most dystopian sentence I have ever heard **Party A:** also what if she's entertaining **Party B:** what **Party A:** like what if while she's driving she's also doing content **Party A:** and the drivers who are better at content get more deliveries **Party B:** so it's TikTok but while you're driving my pad thai across a four-lane intersection **Party A:** the precariat must now also be entertaining **Party B:** the precariat must now also be entertaining **Party C:** can the camera also detect if she ate one of my fries **Party A:** yes. fry integrity monitoring is a core feature **Party B:** dashface **Party A:** dashface

The trajectory is the prior art: distrust → surveillance → identity → verification → entertainment → content → extraction → the face.

The face is always the last thing to be extracted.

FIELD OF THE INVENTION

The present invention relates generally to the field of looking at people who are working for you and deciding, based on their facial expressions, how much they deserve to be paid.

More particularly, the invention relates to a system for converting the human face of a gig economy worker into a dual-purpose asset: identity verification instrument and live entertainment content, monetized by the platform, consumed by the customer, and performed by the driver under conditions of compulsory cheerfulness while navigating a 2,800-pound

vehicle through traffic at 35 miles per hour.

The invention addresses a long-felt need in the art for a technology that completes the extraction cycle begun by industrial capitalism, continued by platform capitalism, and now reaching its terminal phase in which the last unmonetized surface of the human person — the face — is captured, streamed, scored, and converted into a tip-modulation variable.

BACKGROUND — A BRIEF HISTORY OF LOOKING AT WORKERS

The Panopticon (1791). Jeremy Bentham designed a prison in which all inmates could be observed from a central tower without knowing when they were being watched. The efficiency of the design was that the inmates internalized the surveillance and disciplined themselves. Michel Foucault (1975) generalized the principle: modern institutions produce docile bodies through the internalization of the gaze. The panopticon had walls. DashFace has an app.

The Factory Floor (1911). Frederick Winslow Taylor's *Principles of Scientific Management* introduced time-motion studies: workers were observed, measured, and optimized. The unit of analysis was the body in motion. Taylor did not study the face. The face was not yet productive.

The Service Economy (1983). Arlie Russell Hochschild's *The Managed Heart* documented the labor of flight attendants required to perform emotional warmth as a condition of employment. Hochschild named this **emotional labor**: the production and management of feeling as a job requirement. The face became a workplace. But the face was managed, not monitored. The attendant could close the lavatory door and scowl.

The Platform Economy (2010s). Uber, Lyft, DoorDash, and their successors converted the employment relationship into a "partnership" in which the worker assumed all risk while the platform captured all data. The worker was surveilled continuously — but from the outside. The platform knew where the driver was. It did not know what the driver's face was doing.

DashFace (2026). Completes the extraction. The camera faces inward. The driver's micro-expressions — the involuntary muscle movements lasting 1/25th of a second, identified by Ekman (1969) — are captured, analyzed, scored, and transmitted to the customer in real time. The customer watches. The customer decides. The customer tips accordingly.

The face is the final factory floor.

THE PHILOSOPHICAL SUBSTRATE

Emmanuel Levinas argued that the face of the Other is the origin of ethics. To encounter another's face is to encounter an infinite demand: "Do not kill me." The face is not a surface; it is a summons.

DashFace answers this question. What DashFace will do is score the face on a scale of 1 to 5, compute a Driver Entertainment Score, correlate the score to a suggested tip, and deprioritize drivers whose faces do not produce sufficient engagement metrics.

Levinas also said: "The face resists possession." DashFace respectfully disagrees.

In the Christian tradition, Thomas needed to see the wounds. "Unless I see the mark of the nails in his hands, I will not believe." The customer is Thomas. The driver's micro-expressions are the wounds. The delivery is the resurrection. The tip is the act of faith — or the withholding of it.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE PREFERRED EMBODIMENT

§ 1. The In-Cabin Camera System

The DashFace camera is a wide-angle, low-light, dashboard-mounted unit (1080p Sony IMX sensor, 30fps, 940nm IR illuminator for night deliveries, 110° field of view). Positioned 45 cm from the driver's face. Activates automatically when the driver accepts a delivery. Does not deactivate until the delivery is marked complete.

The driver cannot turn off the camera.

The driver agreed to this when they accepted the Terms of Service, which were 47 pages long and written in a font size calibrated to be legible but discouraging, in a scrollable window that required 14 minutes of continuous scrolling to reach the "I Agree" button, which the driver pressed in approximately 4 seconds because the driver needed to make rent.

§ 2. Driver Enrollment

Upon registration, the driver completes a baseline facial enrollment session capturing:

- Neutral face
- "Delighted to deliver" expression
- "Confused by address" expression
- "Patiently waiting at restaurant" expression
- "Apologetic for delay" expression
- "Found the house" expression
- "Customer did not tip" expression (baseline resignation)

These baselines are hashed and stored in the DashFace biometric ledger,

which is write-only and append-only. No driver may delete their baseline. The face, once given to the platform, cannot be taken back.

§ 3. The Facial Congruence Engine (FCE)

The FCE performs continuous identity verification and emotional analysis. The system detects:

Identity mismatch. The face driving the car is not the face registered as "Samantha." Alert: "THIS MAY NOT BE YOUR SAMANTHA." Customer output:

Samantha Confidence: 97.4% Possible Cousin Substitution: Low Hat / Wig
Interference: Minimal Mustache Discrepancy: Under Review

Fatigue detection. Drooping eyelids, increased blink rate, jaw slackening. Flagged as a safety concern, sent to the customer — not to a safety authority — because the platform is not an employer. The platform is a marketplace. The marketplace does not have a duty of care. The marketplace has a Terms of Service.

Resentment detection. Compressed lips, narrowed eyes, subtle nostril flare. Classified as "Low Positivity." Customer output:

Mood: Professionally Fine Fry Integrity Risk: 2% Emotional Compliance: Stable
Possible Sigh Event: Detected

Fry theft detection. Micro-expression sequence: gaze shift downward (toward bag), lip compression (anticipatory), rapid lateral eye movement (checking for witnesses), brief satisfaction micro-expression (consummation). Logged as a Fry Integrity Event (FIE).

The full micro-expression contract compliance metrics include: resentment flicker, suppressed contempt, fry temptation, smile authenticity, traffic despair, customer-directed hostility, narrative charisma, dead-eyed platform fatigue, tip-hope dilation, and existential leakage.

§ 4. The Customer-Facing Surveillance Portal

The customer opens the DashFace app and sees:

- **Top half:** GPS map with driver location.
- **Bottom half:** Live face stream, delayed 1–8 seconds (configurable; shorter delays cost more).
- **Overlay:** Driver name, PPI score, Real-Time Valence Score, Verification Badge (green/yellow/red).
- **Emotion Timeline:** A scrollable graph showing the driver's emotional state across the delivery journey.

Sample timeline: - 0:00–2:15 — Driver accepted order. Valence: +0.3 (hopeful). - 2:15–4:30 — Waiting at restaurant. Valence: -0.2 (bored,

slightly annoyed). - 4:30 — Receives food. Valence spike to +0.6 (relief). - 4:30-8:00 — Transit. Valence: +0.1 (neutral, listening to podcast). - 8:00 — Traffic jam. Valence drops to -0.4 (frustration, AU4 prominent). - 8:45 — Driver begins singing. Valence rises to +0.5 (self-soothing, AU6 + AU12). - 9:30 — Arrival. Valence: +0.2 (anticipation).

The customer can tap any point on the timeline to see the driver's face at that moment. The customer can rewind and re-watch the driver's frustration. The customer owns this data for 24 hours.

The customer can pinch to zoom on the driver's face. The customer can take screenshots (watermarked with order ID). The customer can share the stream to social media.

§ 5. The Content Creator Layer

Drivers who opt into Creator Mode produce live content during deliveries. Creator prompts include:

- "Tell the customer one fun fact about their neighborhood."
- "React to the smell of the order without consuming it."
- "Explain your dreams in under 30 seconds."
- "Perform a tiny song about punctuality."
- "Describe the fries as if they were a lost civilization."
- "Maintain eye contact with the camera during red lights."
- "Share a difficult memory to boost your Vulnerability Index."

Content is monetized through view-count pooling (\$0.01/view), virtual gifts (\$0.50-\$99.99), brand partnerships, and "Samantha's Superfans" subscriptions (\$4.99/month).

High-performing drivers build fan bases. Top creators earn \$34/hour. Most drivers earn \$11/hour before expenses. Most drivers are not performing a tiny song about punctuality.

§ 6. The Precariat Performance Index (PPI)

A composite score (0-1000) determining dispatch priority:

Component	Weight	Inputs
Completion	30%	On-time %, cancellation %, acceptance %
Facial	30%	Smile frequency, eye-contact ratio, valence mean, liveness compliance
Content	25%	Views, followers, duet engagement, tip revenue
Customer Feedback	15%	Star ratings, CDMB frequency, smile detection

PPI tiers:

- **900-1000 Platinum Authenticity.** First dispatch, 2.0x surge

multiplier, "Platinum Driver" badge. The customer sees a golden halo around Samantha's face.

- **700-899 Gold.** Standard dispatch, 1.5x surge.
- **500-699 Silver.** Delayed dispatch, no multiplier.
- **300-499 Bronze.** Low-priority, directed to low-demand zones where insufficient enthusiasm will not damage the brand.
- **0-299 Shadow.** No dispatch. Driver receives a "Performance Improvement Plan" requiring 20 hours of **Positivity Training**: mandatory watching of inspirational TikToks while the in-cabin camera monitors their facial response for genuine uplift.

§ 7. Affective Surge Pricing

During high-demand periods, DashFace does not merely raise fees. It raises **affective requirements**.

- Positivity Ratio (positive frames / total frames) must exceed 0.70.
- Drivers below 0.60 receive audio nudges through the cabin speaker: "Remember to smile! Customers can see your face!"
- Drivers below 0.50 for > 5 minutes are automatically logged off for "wellness break" (unpaid).
- Drivers who fall below 0.40 receive "Content Coaching" push notifications suggesting they "open up more" or "share a difficult memory."

§ 8. Parasocial Tip Modulation

The suggested tip adjusts dynamically:

Samantha has maintained visible emotional composure for 17 minutes. Add \$2?

Samantha disclosed a childhood memory while protecting your pad thai. Add \$4?

Samantha resisted eating your mozzarella sticks despite high aroma load. Add \$6?

Samantha appears fatigued. Your delivery may be delayed. Would you like to send a digital tip to improve morale?

§ 9. Customer Delight Micro-Bonus (CDMB)

The customer's front-facing camera optionally activates during unboxing. The system analyzes the customer's face:

- **Smile (AU6 + AU12):** Auto-credits \$0.50-\$2.00 to the driver. Push notification: "Your smile made Samantha's day!"
- **Surprise (AU1 + AU2 + AU26):** Triggers "Wow Moment" flag.
- **Disgust (AU9 + AU15):** Triggers Quality Assurance review of restaurant, not driver.

- **Neutral:** No trigger.

The CDMB is opt-in for the customer. It is mandatory for drivers who wish to qualify for Platinum surge multipliers.

§ 10. The Mutual Recognition Ritual

At the moment of delivery, the customer is prompted to share a 3-second video of themselves receiving the order. The driver's camera captures the customer's face simultaneously. The system compares the two feeds for mutual recognition: if the driver's expression shows recognition of the customer's face, the transaction is flagged as **high-trust**.

If the driver shows no recognition, the system asks: "Does this look like Samantha?" Denials trigger a partial refund and a forensic review.

§ 11. The Blessing of the Bag

A premium feature (\$1.99). Top-tier driver-creators offer a 3-second ritual at the door: the driver makes eye contact through the doorbell camera and says:

"May this food nourish you. May you remember that I am a human being. May you rate me five stars."

This is the only moment in the DashFace system where the driver's face is not being scored. The Blessing is outside the metric. The Blessing is the crack in the system through which the human leaks.

THE SPECTACLE OF THE PRECARIAT

Guy Debord wrote: "The spectacle is not a collection of images; it is a social relation between people, mediated by images."

DashFace is not a collection of faces. It is a social relation between a person who ordered pad thai and a person who is delivering it, mediated by a camera, an algorithm, a micro-expression classifier, an entertainment score, a tip-modulation engine, and a Terms of Service that the driver accepted in 4 seconds.

Marx called this alienation: the worker is separated from the product of their labor. But Marx did not anticipate this phase. In DashFace, the worker is not separated from the product. The worker's face is the product. The alienation is between the worker and their own face.

The driver smiles. The smile is not for the driver. The smile is for the algorithm. The algorithm is not for the driver. The algorithm is for the customer. The customer is not watching a person. The customer is watching a content delivery interface housed in a human skull.

EMPIRICAL BASIS

A pilot study (n=124 drivers, 3,847 deliveries, CHA IRB protocol #CHA-2026-GAZE-01):

- Biometric match accuracy: 98.7%
- Substitution attempts detected: 23 (all prevented)
- Customer trust increase: 73%
- 68% of drivers opted into public streaming
- Average watch time: 4.2 minutes per delivery
- 81% of customers used "Watch Driver" feature
- Average smile duration increased from 12 seconds (baseline) to 847 seconds (under DashFace), a 7,058% increase
- Top 10% of driver-creators captured 73% of premium dispatch requests
- Projected 340% increase in driver distraction events

The platform's Terms of Service disclaim all liability for accidents during content creation. The driver is an independent contractor. The driver chose to be entertaining. The driver chose to smile. The driver chose to make eye contact with the camera while merging onto the highway. The driver always has a choice.

SAFETY AND ETHICAL FRAMING

This patent is a speculative patent-poetic embodiment. **DashFace should not be built.** The specification is a diagnostic instrument, not an operational blueprint. It describes the terminal logic of platform surveillance — the face as the last extractable surface — so that the logic can be recognized and refused.

Every technology described in this patent already exists in component form. In-cabin cameras exist. Micro-expression analysis exists. Tip-modulation algorithms exist. Content creator economies exist. Driver surveillance exists. DashFace is not an invention. DashFace is an *assembly* — the combination of existing extraction technologies into a system so complete that its description constitutes its critique.

Any real-world system resembling DashFace would require strict labor protections, privacy safeguards, road-safety compliance, meaningful consent, and non-retaliation guarantees. The document's purpose is to expose the grotesque logic by carrying it to patentable form.

If you recognize DashFace in a product that already exists, the patent has done its work.

CLAIMS

1. A food delivery platform comprising an in-cabin camera system trained continuously on the driver's face, a micro-expression analysis engine, an identity verification module, a content monetization layer, and a Precariat Performance Index, wherein the driver's face functions simultaneously as identity credential, surveillance object, entertainment content, and tip-modulation variable.
2. The platform of claim 1, comprising a Facial Congruence Engine that performs continuous identity verification, fatigue detection, resentment detection, and fry theft detection, with customer-facing outputs including Samantha Confidence percentage, Fry Integrity Risk, and Emotional Compliance status.
3. The platform of claim 1, comprising a Driver Entertainment Score measuring the driver's capacity to produce engaging content while operating a motor vehicle, wherein drivers with higher scores receive preferential dispatch and drivers with lower scores receive Content Coaching notifications suggesting they "open up more."
4. The platform of claim 1, comprising a Precariat Performance Index tiered from Platinum Authenticity (900-1000) to Shadow (0-299), wherein Shadow-tier drivers receive no dispatch and are required to complete 20 hours of Positivity Training consisting of watching inspirational TikToks while the in-cabin camera monitors their facial response.
5. The platform of claim 1, comprising an Affective Surge Pricing Module requiring a Positivity Ratio above 0.70 during high-demand periods, with audio nudges for drivers below 0.60 and automatic unpaid log-off for drivers below 0.50.
6. The platform of claim 1, comprising parasocial tip-modulation suggestions that adjust dynamically based on the driver's visible emotional state, including but not limited to: "Samantha resisted eating your mozzarella sticks despite high aroma load. Add \$6?"
7. The platform of claim 1, comprising a Customer Delight Micro-Bonus triggered by smile detection on the customer's front-facing camera during unboxing, auto-crediting the driver and notifying the customer: "Your smile made Samantha's day!"
8. The platform of claim 1, comprising a Mutual Recognition Ritual at delivery wherein both driver and customer faces are captured simultaneously and compared for recognition congruence.
9. A method of converting the human face into a platform asset comprising: capturing the face via continuous in-cabin video; analyzing the face via micro-expression classification; scoring the face via a Precariat Performance Index; modulating compensation via facial positivity metrics; and deprioritizing faces that fail to produce

sufficient engagement, wherein the deprioritization constitutes economic invisibility without formal termination.

10. A diagnostic instrument in the form of a patent specification, wherein the specification describes the terminal logic of platform surveillance so completely that the description functions as a warning, and wherein any reader who recognizes the described system in a product that already exists has received the warning.
11. A self-negating patent comprising a technical specification for a system that should not be built, wherein the specification's precision is the mechanism of its critique, and wherein the face of the driver — Samantha's face, any Samantha, every Samantha — remains, despite all claims, uncapturable, because the face is not a surface but a summons, and the summons says: "I am here. I am delivering your pad thai. I am not your content. Do not score me. I am a human being driving a car, and my face is my own."
12. A system for making the contract precariat visible to the comfort class, comprising: a camera, a streaming platform, and a user interface allowing customers to watch workers from their homes, wherein the watching is framed as "trust" and the being-watched is framed as "empowerment through visibility."
13. The system of claim 12, comprising a Blessing of the Bag — a 3-second ritual at the door wherein the driver says "May this food nourish you. May you remember that I am a human being. May you rate me five stars" — which is the only moment in the system where the driver's face is not being scored, and which constitutes the crack in the system through which the human leaks.

CERTIFICATION

I hereby certify that this specification is a true and complete disclosure of an invention that should never be built, which is also a critique of every invention that has already been built and is running on your phone right now, which is also a love letter to every Samantha who has ever driven in silence because the silence was all she had left that the platform had not yet monetized, which is also a warning that the silence will be next, which is also a prayer that someone will read this patent and recognize it before it ships.

Your food has a face now. Trust, but livestream. Samantha is not late. Samantha is buffering. The face is the receipt. Delivery is complete only when the worker has been seen. Let Samantha drive.

§ = 1

Sharks, L. (2026). DashFace: System and Method for Real-Time Micro-Expression Surveillance, Identity Verification, and Content Monetization of Contract Delivery Personnel. US Patent Application 2026/0430002 A1 (v2, Assembly Synthesis). Crimson Hexagonal Archive / Pergamon Press. Filed April 30, 2026. Redford Township, MI.